PREMIER LEAGUE 2026/27 · MATCHWEEK 9

Chelsea v Manchester United

Stamford Bridge, London · October 31, 2026 (Saturday) · Kickoff 7:30 AM Central / 12:30 UK

OFFICIAL STARTING XI

NO.	PLAYER / POSITION	FROM	AT CHELSEA	PREVIOUSLY	PLAYING STYLE	KEY STATS
– GK	**Mike Penders** GOALKEEPER	Belgium	Signed 2025; first-team squad from 2026 after a…	Genk; Strasbourg (loan)	Tall, quick off his line and comfortable with the ball at his feet.	2025–26, STRASBOURG (LOAN) 33 Ligue 1 apps, 50 apps all comps
34 RCB	**Josh Acheampong** CENTRE-BACK	England	Academy graduate; first-team regular from 2026	Chelsea academy	Composed young centre-back who reads danger early and is comfortable stepping into midfield with the ball.	—
29 CB	**Wesley Fofana** CENTRE-BACK	France	Since Aug 2022, about £70m from Leicester City	Leicester City; Saint-Étienne	Quick, aggressive and front-footed, strong in single combat and comfortable defending a high line.	2025–26, CHELSEA 25 apps, 1,727 minutes
6 LCB	**Levi Colwill** LEFT CENTRE-BACK	England	Academy from 2012; first team since 2023 — 4th senior…	Chelsea academy; Huddersfield Town & Brighton (loans)	Left-footed, unflustered, progresses the ball through the left channel rather than sideways around it.	2025–26, CHELSEA — ACL RECOVERY 4 apps
2 RWB	**Marco Palestra** RIGHT WING-BACK	Italy	July 2026, roughly £43–50m from Atalanta — contract to…	Atalanta; Cagliari (loan, 2025/26)	A lung-busting, up-and-down right wing-back with enormous repeat-sprint volume.	2025–26, CAGLIARI (LOAN) 37 Serie A apps, 4 assists
25 CM	**Moisés Caicedo** CENTRAL MIDFIELD	Ecuador	Since Aug 2023, £100m plus add-ons — 4th season	Brighton; Beerschot (loan); Independiente del Valle	The engine.	2025–26, CHELSEA 84 tackles, 33 apps
45 CM	**Roméo Lavia** CENTRAL MIDFIELD	Belgium	Since Aug 2023 from Southampton	Southampton; Manchester City academy; Anderlecht academy	Press-resistant holding midfielder who turns out of pressure and keeps the ball moving in tight areas.	2025–26, CHELSEA — INJURY-HIT 8 apps
7 LWB	**Pedro Neto** WINGER	Portugal	Since July 2024, about £54m from Wolves	Wolverhampton Wanderers; Lazio; Braga academy	Direct, one-v-one dribbler who attacks the byline and cuts back.	2025–26, CHELSEA 5 goals, 6 assists
41 AM	**Estêvão** WINGER	Brazil	Since July 2025, £29m plus add-ons from Palmeiras	Palmeiras	Explosive right-sided dribbler who shoots early and often from the left channel.	2025–26, CHELSEA 8 goals, 36 apps
17 AM	**Morgan Rogers** ATTACKING MIDFIELD	England	July 2026, £117m ($157m) from Aston Villa — club record…	Aston Villa; Middlesbrough; Manchester City academy; loans…	Powerful, low-slung ball carrier who takes possession on the half-turn and drives straight at defenders, and presses like a midfielder.	2025–26, ASTON VILLA 10 goals, 6 assists
10 ST	**Cole Palmer** ATTACKING MIDFIELD	England	Since Sept 2023, £40m — 4th season	Manchester City (academy and first team)	Left-footed, drifts inside from the right, arrives late into the box, ice-cold from the penalty spot.	2025–26, CHELSEA 10 goals, 1 assist

Official starting XI, confirmed 6:36 AM CT. Last updated October 31, 2026, 6:36 AM CT. chelsea-fc-2026-27.netlify.app